MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Hands-on experience building GitLab CI workflows and Helm-based ephemeral environments on a shared Kubernetes cluster, with personal projects in k3s, GitOps, monitoring and Terraform. Experienced in improving pipeline performance, reliability and team visibility through automation and clear technical documentation. Transitioning toward DevOps and platform engineering, with hands-on experience in CI/CD infrastructure, Kubernetes test environments, infrastructure automation and observability.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & delivery: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test environments), k3s, Argo CD, Terraform (personal project; Hetzner VPS provisioning)

Monitoring & observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki; test metrics dashboards

Programming & data: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, PostgreSQL

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Systems & tooling: Linux, Git, Ansible (basic), cert-manager, Traefik

Cloud learning: AWS (EC2 and S3 basics; personal learning)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) *2021–Present*
Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling pipelines, parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner cost decreased by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request environments with Docker Compose and later Helm charts on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data; they are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed PostgreSQL test data and collect CI test results into PostgreSQL for Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Authored the internal guide to how CI works, used for team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023 and enabled QA and product teams to review merge-request environments before merge.

QA Engineer *2019–2021*
Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) *2018–2019*
Brightmill Software House

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps *2024–2025*
Personal

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for SSL/TLS certificate management.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments *2023–2024*
Odrava Health

- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge by deploying a short-lived application and PostgreSQL environment for each merge request from GitLab CI.
- Ran end-to-end tests against the environments and automated cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

CI Pipeline Speed-up *2022*
Odrava Health

- Profiled pipelines across three teams and improved execution through parallel test jobs, dependency caching and a separate end-to-end stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner cost by about 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

Flaky Test Dashboard *2023*
Odrava Health

- Collected CI test results through the GitLab API into PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team; the flaky rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams addressed the top offenders.
- Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering *2018*
Silesian Lowlands University of Technology

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation; exam booked for January 2027

Terraform Associate practice tests completed; exam not taken

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)